

ACADEMY BEYOND THIS WORLD

SCENE-BY-SCENE ILLUSTRATION BRIEF

TOM 1 — The Hidden System | Complete Page-by-Page Production Guide

Page Type Legend

Code	Type	Description	Illustration Requirement
TEXT ONLY	Text Only	Narrative prose, no illustration required	None — typography and layout only
TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Text + Illustration	Prose with accompanying artwork	Full illustration brief provided
ILLUSTRATION ONLY	Illustration Only	Full-page or spread artwork, minimal text	Full illustration brief provided

Illustration Brief Format: Each scene card includes Location, Lighting, Colour Palette, Characters Present, Action/Content, Anomaly Level (if applicable), and Production Notes.

FRONT MATTER

SCENE FM-01 [ILLUSTRATION ONLY]

Cover Page — The Hidden System

Location: Academy exterior — grand domed building, night sky, stars

Lighting: Deep cool night — moonlight key, warm gold from windows, volumetric star glow

Colour Palette: Deep navy #0B132B, warm gold #E2D7B5, starlight purple #7A5CFF

Characters: None — establishing world image

Action / Content: Grand academy building at night. Stars visible. Sense of mystery and wonder. Title treatment integrated into architecture.

Anomaly Level: None

Notes: This is the reader's first impression of the world. Warm, inviting, mysterious. NOT dark or threatening.

SCENE FM-02 [TEXT ONLY]

Copyright & Publication Page

Location: N/A

Lighting: N/A

Colour Palette: N/A

Characters: N/A

Action / Content: Copyright notice, publisher information, ISBN, edition details

Notes: Clean typography. No illustration required.

SCENE FM-03 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Dedication Page — 'What if nothing around you needs to change...'

Location: Abstract — soft light, open space

Lighting: Warm, soft, intimate — whisper intensity (Level 1)

Colour Palette: Warm gold, soft cream, pale amber

Characters: None — abstract/symbolic

Action / Content: Poetic dedication text. Small decorative element — perhaps a single glowing symbol or constellation motif.

Anomaly Level: None

Notes: Minimal, elegant. The text is the focus.

SCENE FM-04 [TEXT ONLY]

Table of Contents

Location: N/A

Lighting: N/A

Colour Palette: N/A

Characters: N/A

Action / Content: Five parts listed with chapter titles. Part symbols: purple circle (Part I), blue circle (Part II), yellow circle (Part III), crescent moon (Part IV), stars (Part V), sparkle (Epilogue)

Notes: Part symbols should match the emotional colour of each section.

PART I — NOTICING

| *The world is layered. Nothing is always as it seems.*

SCENE 1.1 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 1 — Something Is Not Right | First Blur

Location: Main Academy Corridor — afternoon, pale walls, polished stone, tall windows

Lighting: Warm afternoon light through windows, long thinning bands of light on floor, slightly heavier air quality

Colour Palette: Warm gold, pale stone, soft amber, washed blue sky through windows

Characters: Astra — slowing down, sensing something wrong

Action / Content: Astra walks the corridor. Everything looks normal. But something doesn't feel right. She slows. The corridor is exactly as it should be — and yet.

Anomaly Level: None — pre-anomaly state

Notes: This is the reader's first view of Astra and the corridor. Establish the normal world beautifully before anything shifts. Astra viewed from behind or three-quarter angle.

SCENE 1.2 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 2 — The Shadow That Didn't Move

Location: Main Academy Corridor — same location, moments later

Lighting: Same warm afternoon light — but one shadow is wrong. It doesn't move when it should.

Colour Palette: Same warm palette — but introduce a single cool note where the shadow is

Characters: Astra — stopped, staring at the shadow

Action / Content: Astra notices a shadow that doesn't move with the light. First anomaly. She doubts herself.

Anomaly Level: Subtle — Level 1 (Whisper). Shadow delay only.

Notes: *The anomaly must be subtle enough that the reader might also doubt it. Don't over-dramatise.*

SCENE 1.3 [TEXT ONLY]

Chapter 3 — The Second Time

Location: N/A — interior monologue and corridor

Lighting: N/A

Colour Palette: N/A

Characters: Astra

Action / Content: Astra processes what she saw. Tries to rationalise. Walks the corridor again. The shadow is normal now.

Notes: *Text only — internal experience. No illustration needed.*

SCENE 1.4 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 4 — Did You See That?

Location: Academy Corridor — near classroom entrance

Lighting: Warm corridor light, slight flicker at the edge of perception

Colour Palette: Warm gold with first hint of cool purple at edges

Characters: Astra + background students (unaware)

Action / Content: Astra tries to ask another student if they saw it. They didn't. She is alone in her perception.

Anomaly Level: Subtle — Level 1. Barely visible symbol flicker in background.

Notes: *Other students should look completely normal and unaware. Astra is isolated in her perception.*

SCENE 1.5 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 5 — A Pattern That Doesn't Belong

Location: Notebook Space — Astra's study area

Lighting: Warm lantern light, golden afternoon through window, intimate

Colour Palette: Warm amber, aged parchment, deep navy notebook

Characters: Astra — writing, drawing patterns

Action / Content: Astra begins recording what she's seen in her notebook. The pattern emerges on the page. First moment of the notebook reacting.

Anomaly Level: Subtle — Level 1–2. Notebook pattern glows faintly.

Notes: *This is the Notebook Space scene. Show the warm, intimate study environment. The notebook is central.*

PART II — UNDERSTANDING

SCENE 2.1 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 1 — Lumi

Location: Academy Library — research tables section

Lighting: Warm amber library light, focused task lighting on Lumi's table, books everywhere

Colour Palette: Warm amber, terracotta, deep navy, cream paper

Characters: Lumi — alone, surrounded by books and notes, glasses, focused

Action / Content: Introduction of Lumi. She is already researching. Books open, notes everywhere. She searches for answers through logic.

Anomaly Level: None

Notes: *Lumi's introduction should feel intellectual and warm. She is at home here. Show her analytical nature through her environment.*

SCENE 2.2 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 2 — *The Notebook That Doesn't Match*

Location: Library — Lumi's research table

Lighting: Focused task light, warm amber, slight cool note from Lumi's analytical energy

Colour Palette: Warm amber + cool blue-white from Lumi's notes

Characters: Lumi + Astra (meeting)

Action / Content: Astra and Lumi compare notebooks. Lumi's logical notes and Astra's pattern observations don't match — but together they reveal something.

Anomaly Level: Subtle — Level 2. Patterns on both notebooks briefly align and glow.

Notes: *First meeting of Astra and Lumi. The moment their notebooks align is the key visual beat.*

SCENE 2.3 [TEXT ONLY]

Chapter 3 — *There Are Rules*

Location: N/A

Lighting: N/A

Colour Palette: N/A

Characters: Lumi (narrating/explaining)

Action / Content: Lumi explains her theory — the anomalies follow rules. They are not random. This is a system.

Notes: *Text only — exposition through dialogue. No illustration needed.*

SCENE 2.4 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 4 — *Nela*

Location: Academy Common Room / Corridor — energetic space

Lighting: Warm, lively, practical light — common room energy

Colour Palette: Warm gold, orange, amber — Nela's warm palette

Characters: Nela — energetic, curly hair, orange jacket, surrounded by sparks of energy

Action / Content: Introduction of Nela. She is already doing something — fixing, building, making. She trusts what she feels before she understands it.

Anomaly Level: None

Notes: *Nela's introduction should feel energetic and warm. She is action-oriented. Show her through what she's doing, not just who she is.*

SCENE 2.5 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 5 — *Don't Ask. Just Hold This.*

Location: Corridor — transitional space

Lighting: Mixed warm/cool — transition lighting

Colour Palette: Warm gold + cool blue, balanced

Characters: Nela + Astra (first interaction)

Action / Content: Nela hands Astra something — an object, a tool, a piece of the puzzle. She doesn't explain. She just acts.

Anomaly Level: Subtle — Level 2. Object glows faintly in Astra's hands.

Notes: This is the first moment of the trio beginning to form. The object connecting them is important.

PART III — CONNECTING

SCENE 3.1 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 1 — The First Symbol

Location: Observation Corridor — symbol emergence location

Lighting: Soft ambient with symbol light emerging — cool blue-white geometric glow

Colour Palette: Deep navy, cool blue, gold symbol light

Characters: Astra — alone, witnessing first clear symbol

Action / Content: Astra sees the first clear symbol. Not a flicker — a full, stable geometric pattern on the floor. She is certain now.

Anomaly Level: Moderate — Level 3. Clear symbol visible, stable, geometric.

Notes: This is the first unambiguous anomaly. The symbol should be beautiful, not threatening. Compass rose or star geometry.

SCENE 3.2 [TEXT ONLY]

Chapter 2 — If It Means Something...

Location: N/A

Lighting: N/A

Colour Palette: N/A

Characters: Astra + Lumi (dialogue)

Action / Content: Astra tells Lumi about the symbol. Lumi begins to theorise. If it means something, it can be understood.

Notes: Text only — key dialogue scene. No illustration needed.

SCENE 3.3 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 3 — Try It Again

Location: Observation Corridor — same location

Lighting: Soft ambient, anticipatory — slightly warmer than before

Colour Palette: Deep navy, warm gold anticipation, cool blue symbol zones

Characters: Astra + Lumi — together, testing

Action / Content: They return to the location. Lumi observes while Astra tries to recreate the conditions. The symbol appears again — but only when Astra is paying attention.

Anomaly Level: Moderate — Level 3. Symbol appears in response to Astra's attention.

Notes: The key insight: the system responds to attention. This is the activation logic beginning to reveal itself.

SCENE 3.4 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 4 — It Reacted

Location: Observation Corridor — activation moment

Lighting: Strong light — Level 4. Symbol fully active, geometric patterns spreading

Colour Palette: Deep navy, bright gold symbol light, cool blue energy

Characters: Astra + Lumi — witnessing together

Action / Content: The symbol reacts to them. It changes. It responds. The world is not passive.

Anomaly Level: Strong — Level 4. Symbol active, spreading patterns, architecture responding.

Notes: This is a major visual moment. The symbol should feel alive and responsive, not threatening.

SCENE 3.5 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 5 — The Three of Us

Location: Corridor — trio gathering point

Lighting: Mixed warm/cool — balanced, hopeful

Colour Palette: Warm gold + cool blue + Nela's amber — all three character palettes present

Characters: Astra + Lumi + Nela — first time all three together

Action / Content: Nela joins. The trio is complete for the first time. Something shifts when all three are present.

Anomaly Level: Moderate — Level 3. Subtle symbol alignment when all three are together.

Notes: This is the trio's first complete gathering. The visual should feel like something clicking into place.

PART IV — ACTIVATING

SCENE 4.1 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 1 — The Corridor Changes

Location: Grand Corridor — glitch state beginning

Lighting: Glitch lighting — warm base with purple/blue energy intrusions, flickering

Colour Palette: Warm gold base + purple/blue glitch energy

Characters: Astra + Lumi + Nela — moving through corridor

Action / Content: The Grand Corridor begins to change. The glitch state activates. Symbols flicker. Reflections delay. The world is shifting.

Anomaly Level: Moderate-Strong — Level 3–4. Glitch state active.

Notes: This is the corridor's glitch state. Show the beautiful strangeness — not horror, but wonder.

SCENE 4.2 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 2 — Focus

Location: Observation Hallway — time dilation zone

Lighting: Time-perception lighting — floating clock arrays, astrolabe instruments, soft blue-white

Colour Palette: Deep navy, soft blue-white, gold clock elements

Characters: Astra — alone, in deep focus, interacting with floating mandala

Action / Content: Astra enters deep focus. Time slows. She sees the rhythm beneath the rhythm. The Observation Hallway responds to her perception.

Anomaly Level: Strong — Level 4. Time dilation visible, clock arrays active.

Notes: This is Astra's signature scene. The floating mandala she interacts with is the key visual element.

SCENE 4.3 [TEXT ONLY]

Chapter 3 — Not Everything Is Visible

Location: N/A

Lighting: N/A

Colour Palette: N/A

Characters: Lumi (internal/dialogue)

Action / Content: Lumi processes what they've discovered. Some things can only be understood, not seen. The system has layers.

Notes: Text only — Lumi's analytical reflection. No illustration needed.

SCENE 4.4 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 4 — Now

Location: Grand Corridor — activation threshold

Lighting: Intense — Level 5. Full activation lighting. Massive geometric patterns, architecture responding.

Colour Palette: Deep navy, brilliant gold, starlight purple — full activation palette

Characters: Astra + Lumi + Nela — trio aligned, activation moment

Action / Content: The trio aligns. All three conditions met simultaneously. The system activates. The corridor transforms.

Anomaly Level: Intense — Level 5. Full activation. Trio alignment symbol — golden star with three points.

Notes: This is the major activation scene. The visual should be awe-inspiring, not overwhelming. Beautiful revelation.

SCENE 4.5 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 5 — The First Gate

Location: Grand Corridor — gate revealed

Lighting: Post-activation — clear, luminous, resolved. Warm gold + cool clarity.

Colour Palette: Warm gold, clear blue-white, deep navy — post-activation palette

Characters: Astra + Lumi + Nela — standing before the gate

Action / Content: The first gate is revealed. A door that wasn't there before. The path forward is open.

Anomaly Level: Moderate — Level 3. Gate glowing, stable, inviting.

Notes: The gate should feel like an invitation, not a threat. Warm light from beyond.

PART V — REALISING

SCENE 5.1 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 1 — The Academy

Location: Grand panoramic — Academy exterior and grounds, full view

Lighting: Golden hour — warm, expansive, revealing

Colour Palette: Full warm palette — amber, gold, deep navy sky, green grounds

Characters: Astra + Lumi + Nela — small figures in grand landscape

Action / Content: The trio sees the Academy as it truly is — not just a school, but a living system. The full scope is revealed.

Anomaly Level: Moderate — Level 3. Symbols visible in architecture for those who look.

Notes: Wide establishing shot. The trio should be small against the grand Academy — emphasising scale and wonder.

SCENE 5.2 [TEXT ONLY]

Chapter 2 — It Was Always There

Location: N/A

Lighting: N/A

Colour Palette: N/A

Characters: All three (dialogue)

Action / Content: The realisation: the system was always there. They didn't create it. They learned to see it.

Notes: Text only — key thematic dialogue. No illustration needed.

SCENE 5.3 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 3 — We're Not Imagining This

Location: Library — research space, evidence gathered

Lighting: Warm library light, focused, triumphant

Colour Palette: Warm amber, gold, cream — library palette

Characters: Astra + Lumi + Nela — surrounded by evidence, notebooks, research

Action / Content: The trio has proof. Their notebooks, observations, and research confirm it. The system is real.

Anomaly Level: Subtle — Level 2. Notebooks glow faintly with aligned patterns.

Notes: *Show the evidence — notebooks, diagrams, research. The intellectual triumph of understanding.*

SCENE 5.4 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Chapter 4 — We Choose to See

Location: Observation Corridor — final scene in this location

Lighting: Clear, luminous, resolved — post-understanding light

Colour Palette: Balanced warm/cool — the mixed profile at its most harmonious

Characters: Astra + Lumi + Nela — standing together, choosing

Action / Content: The trio makes a choice: to keep seeing, to keep understanding, to protect what they've found.

Anomaly Level: Moderate — Level 3. Symbols present but integrated, not overwhelming.

Notes: *This is the emotional climax. The choice to see is the story's core message.*

EPILOGUE

SCENE E.1 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Something Else Is Watching

Location: Academy exterior — night, rooftop or high vantage point

Lighting: Deep night — cool, vast, cosmic. Stars dominant.

Colour Palette: Deep navy, starlight purple, pale gold stars

Characters: Unknown presence — suggested, not shown

Action / Content: The epilogue reveals that something else has been watching. The trio's journey has been noticed. Book 2 is seeded.

Anomaly Level: Subtle — Level 1–2. Something in the shadows, barely visible.

Notes: *Do NOT reveal what is watching. Suggestion only. The reader should feel wonder and slight unease — not fear.*

BONUS PAGES & END MATTER

SCENE B.1 [ILLUSTRATION ONLY]

The Greater Structure — Diagram

Location: Abstract — system diagram

Lighting: Cool, analytical, cosmic

Colour Palette: Deep navy, gold nodes, teal connections

Characters: None — diagram only

Action / Content: The Greater Structure diagram: Observatories (Watch) / Archives (Remember) / Gateways (Connect) / Foundations (Sustain) / Academy (Learn) / Forge (Create). Node diagram with connecting lines.

Anomaly Level: None

Notes: Clean, elegant diagram. Not decorative — functional and beautiful.

SCENE B.2 [TEXT + ILLUSTRATION]

Book 2 Teaser — The Path Beyond

Location: New location — beyond the first gate

Lighting: Unknown — new palette, new world

Colour Palette: Introduce new colours beyond the established palette — hint at expansion

Characters: Astra + Lumi + Nela — small figures at threshold of new world

Action / Content: Brief teaser for Book 2. The path beyond the first gate. What lies ahead.

Anomaly Level: Moderate — Level 3. New symbols, new architecture.

Notes: This should feel like a door opening. Familiar characters, unfamiliar world.

Complete Page Type Summary

Scene	Title	Type	Illustration Required
FM-01	Cover Page	ILLUSTRATION ONLY	Yes — full cover
FM-02	Copyright Page	TEXT ONLY	No
FM-03	Dedication Page	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — small decorative
FM-04	Table of Contents	TEXT ONLY	No
1.1	Something Is Not Right	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — corridor, Astra
1.2	The Shadow That Didn't Move	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — shadow anomaly
1.3	The Second Time	TEXT ONLY	No
1.4	Did You See That?	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — corridor, students
1.5	A Pattern That Doesn't Belong	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — notebook space
2.1	Lumi	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — library, Lumi
2.2	The Notebook That Doesn't Match	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — notebooks aligning
2.3	There Are Rules	TEXT ONLY	No
2.4	Nela	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — common room, Nela
2.5	Don't Ask. Just Hold This.	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — object transfer
3.1	The First Symbol	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — symbol on floor

3.2	If It Means Something...	TEXT ONLY	No
3.3	Try It Again	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — symbol reappears
3.4	It Reacted	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — symbol activation
3.5	The Three of Us	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — trio together
4.1	The Corridor Changes	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — glitch state
4.2	Focus	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — Astra + mandala
4.3	Not Everything Is Visible	TEXT ONLY	No
4.4	Now	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — full activation
4.5	The First Gate	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — gate revealed
5.1	The Academy	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — grand panoramic
5.2	It Was Always There	TEXT ONLY	No
5.3	We're Not Imagining This	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — evidence gathered
5.4	We Choose to See	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — trio choosing
E.1	Something Else Is Watching	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — unknown presence
B.1	The Greater Structure	ILLUSTRATION ONLY	Yes — system diagram
B.2	Book 2 Teaser	TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	Yes — new world threshold

Production Statistics

Type	Count	Percentage
TEXT ONLY	8	26%
TEXT + ILLUSTRATION	20	64%
ILLUSTRATION ONLY	3	10%
TOTAL SCENES	31	100%

Total illustrations required: 23 (20 text+illustration + 3 illustration only)

Text-only pages: 8 (no illustration work required)

Every frame is part of a bigger truth. Every detail matters.